

DECODED EXPLAINED

9th July, 2026

What Is the Right to Be Forgotten?

What is the right to be forgotten?

How does the ruling balance privacy with open justice and free speech? What challenges remain in enforcing the right to be forgotten? What role does the DPDP Act play? Who should decide requests for erasure or de-indexing?

EXPLAINER

G.S. Bajpai

The story so far:

The Delhi High Court, in its recent ruling, has laid down the principles governing the right to be forgotten. The court has evolved a new jurisprudence to protect the privacy of those who continue to be victimised on account of their digital footprints on social media and elsewhere, despite having those matters settled in their favour.

What is the 'right to be forgotten'?

The "right to be forgotten" is the right to have information erased or de-indexed from the public digital environment when its continued accessibility is harmful and serves no public interest.

The concept came to the fore in 2014, when a Spanish citizen, Mario Costeja González, complained to the European Court of Justice that Google continued to display an old newspaper notice about the auction of his repossessed house even though the debt had been settled. The court ruled in his favour, laying the groundwork for the right to erasure, which was later incorporated into Article 17 of the European Union's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

How has the idea of the right to be forgotten evolved in Indian law?

The Supreme Court's judgment in *K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India* (2017) held that privacy is a fundamental right under Article 21, including the right to informational privacy. In the years that followed, however, High Courts adopted divergent approaches.

While some permitted anonymisation in limited cases, such as the Delhi High Court ordering the masking of names in certain matrimonial and criminal matters, others rejected similar requests on



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grounds of open justice.

The real challenge was the lack of a coherent framework to balance these competing interests, which the May 2026 Delhi High Court judgment sought to address.

What did the Delhi High Court decide?

On May 29, the Delhi High Court ruled in a batch of over 30 consolidated petitions, led by *Laksh Vir Singh Yadav v. Union of India*. The core issue was whether informational privacy could justify the de-indexing or masking of judicial records in a system committed to open justice. The court held that the right to be forgotten flows from Article 21's guarantee of dignity and informational privacy. The structured proportionality test is that retention must have a legitimate purpose, that the harm to privacy must be balanced against the public interest, and that the least intrusive means, typically by masking names instead of deleting the entire judgment, should be preferred. The court also prescribed a two-week

deadline for legal databases to comply and explained that only the parties' names should be redacted, not the facts of the case.

How does the right to be forgotten interact with constitutional values?

This is not a stand-alone right. It frequently conflicts with freedom of speech and press under Article 19(1)(a), the principle of open justice, and the public's right to know. A right to privacy must be sacrificed when the public interest is of a high order, particularly in serious cases of crime, but the digital presence should not destroy a person's life long after the trial ends. The judgments are still publicly accessible by case number or a keyword search; only name-based searches are restricted.

What are the practical challenges?

The toughest aspect is enforcement. An acquittal judgment may still appear highly in name-based searches even after a court has ordered the removal of the search results. Search engines are designed so

that the original accusation, or the "shadow of crime," is often the first thing the user sees. De-indexing can benefit at the search level, but it won't prevent mirrors, archive copies, or social media sharing. Without effective technical compliance and coordination among platforms, the right may remain largely symbolic.

What is the relationship between the right to be forgotten and DPDP Act?

As of now, the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, offers a limited statutory right to erasure in section 12. It is primarily based on consent and does not explicitly address judicial records and public archives, where the right to be forgotten is most needed. The Act is deficient because rules have not been notified and the data protection board has not been completely effective.

Who should decide requests for erasure or de-indexing?

The challenge lies in balancing efficiency with accountability. Requiring every request to be decided by a court would create significant bottlenecks, while leaving such decisions entirely to technology companies raises concerns about due process and transparency. A more sensible approach would be a tiered system, where cases could be heard by platforms, contested ones by the data protection board, and judicial cases by courts.

The Delhi High Court has established an important framework, but until the Supreme Court rules on the matter, establishes a data protection board, and platforms comply with it, this ruling will be mostly declaratory. The conflict over freedom of expression and open justice is a reality. The task ahead is now to establish the institutions that facilitate it.

(G. S. Bajpai is Vice Chancellor at National Law University Delhi. He acknowledges the assistance of Vibhuti Sharma, Academic fellow, NLU Delhi. Views are personal)

THE GIST

▼ The Delhi High Court has recognised the right to be forgotten as part of the fundamental right to privacy under Article 21, laying down a framework that balances informational privacy with open justice and freedom of speech by favouring name-masking over deletion of judgments.

▼ While the ruling provides a legal framework for de-indexing and erasure requests, its effectiveness depends on enforcement by platforms, the operationalisation of the DPDP Act, and the establishment of institutions such as the data protection board.

What Is the Right to Be Forgotten?

- **The Concept**

- The "right to be forgotten" allows information to be erased or de-indexed from the public digital environment when its continued accessibility is harmful and serves no public interest

- **Origins**

- Emerged from the 2014 EU case of Mario Costeja González vs Google, later codified as Article 17 of the EU's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)

- **Indian Legal Evolution**

- K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India (2017) held privacy, including informational privacy, to be a fundamental right under Article 21; High Courts thereafter adopted divergent approaches

- **The Delhi High Court Ruling (May 29)**

- In Laksh Vir Singh Yadav v. Union of India, the Court held the right to be forgotten flows from Article 21, prescribing a proportionality test and favouring name-masking over deleting judgments entirely

- **Practical Challenges**

- The DPDP Act, 2023's Section 12 offers only a limited, consent-based right to erasure that doesn't address judicial records; de-indexing doesn't remove mirror sites, archives, or social media copies

Countries Try Again to Seal Pandemic Treaty After Ebola Jolt



The WHO has so far marked 500 deaths and 1,561 confirmed Ebola cases in the DRC, so far.

Countries try again to seal pandemic treaty after Ebola jolt

Agence France Presse
GENEVA

World Health Organisation (WHO) members have kicked off another attempt at finalising the missing piece of the pandemic treaty here on Monday, with the Ebola outbreak in Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC) injecting a fresh sense of urgency.

Wealthy countries and developing nations are at loggerheads in talks at the WHO's headquarters over how the pandemic agreement, adopted last year, will work in practice.

Though the treaty was agreed in May 2023, how its key mechanism would operate was left out to get the deal over the line.

The accord aims at preventing a repeat of the disjointed international response that surrounded COVID-19, by improving global coordination and timely access to vaccines

The agreement (Pathway Access and Benefit-Sharing (PABS) system deals with sharing access to pathogens with pandemic potential, then sharing benefits derived from them such as vaccines, tests, and treatments.

It was meant to be finalised by May 2024, but progress has been agonisingly slow.

Negotiations have often gone late into the night, producing slender advances and leaving diplomats drained. This two-week session until July 17 is the seventh such round of talks.

As the number of confirmed Ebola deaths in the DRC outbreak topped 500, WHO chief Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus urged countries to grasp the nettle.

"Keep the destination in sight," pleaded the UN health agency's Director General.

"A future in which pathogen samples and information move quickly, without needless delay and in which the benefits that come from them reach the people who need them most, fairly and in time."

The Ebola outbreak in the DRC, declared in mid-May, is a "painful" reminder that "the threat never truly goes away", Mr. Ghebreyesus said.

There have been 146 confirmed cases in the DRC, including 586 confirmed deaths, and the outbreak has spilled over into neighbouring Uganda.

"Danger can emerge from anywhere, at any time, in ways we don't always expect," he added.

Before last month's 67 summit, the WHO chief and Brazilian President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva urged its leaders to find the "political will" themselves ensure the PABS annex gets finalised, and "treat July 17 as a deadline, not a milestone".

The pandemic agreement was struck after more than three years of negotiations sparked by the shock of COVID-19.

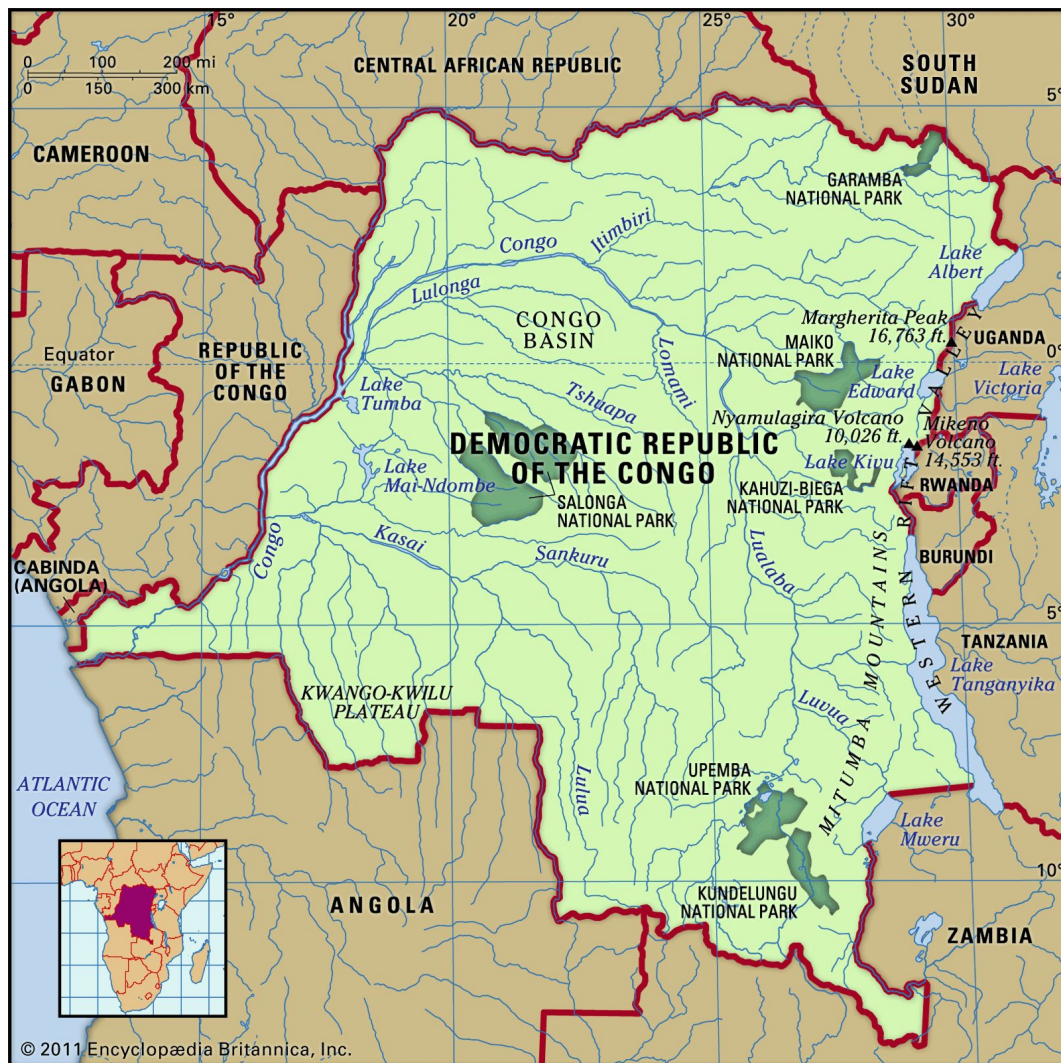
The accord aims at preventing a repeat of the disjointed international response that surrounded the coronavirus crisis, by improving global coordination, surveillance and access to vaccines.

The Third World Network, an NGO that has monitored the negotiations, has insisted that meaningful progress requires developed countries coming down from their maximalist positions and adopting a positive and a constructive outlook.

Countries Try Again to Seal Pandemic Treaty After Ebola Jolt

- Ebola virus was first discovered in 1976 near the **Ebola River** in what is now the Democratic Republic of Congo.
- It most commonly **affects people and nonhuman primates** (such as monkeys, gorillas, and chimpanzees).
- Ebola is a severe and often **deadly viral disease** caused by a group of viruses known as ortho ebola viruses
- The virus is transmitted to people from wild animals (such as fruit bats, porcupines, and non-human primates).
- It then spreads in the human population through direct contact with the blood, secretions, organs, or other bodily fluids of infected people and with surfaces and materials contaminated with these fluids.
- **Ebola cannot be transmitted by air.**

Countries Try Again to Seal Pandemic Treaty After Ebola Jolt



It should not be confused with the Republic of Congo, whose capital is Brazzaville. Both countries lie near the Congo River, but they are separate states.

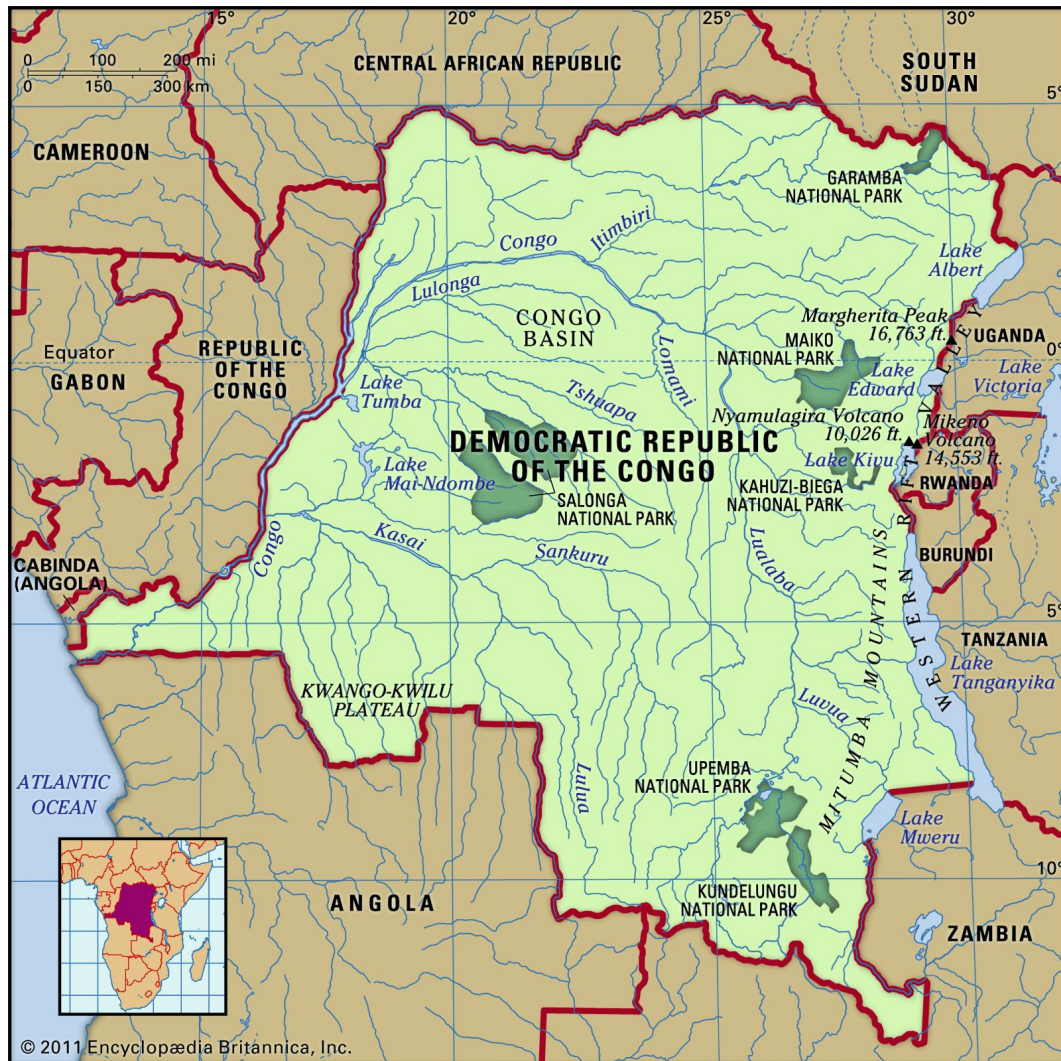
The DRC, Africa's 2nd-largest country, shares borders with Angola, the Republic of the Congo, the Central African Republic, South Sudan, Uganda, Rwanda, Burundi, Tanzania, and Zambia.

The country also has a coastline on the Atlantic Ocean to the southwest.

It has the mineral-rich Katanga Plateau (cobalt, copper, tin, uranium, diamonds). DRC as the world's largest producer of cobalt and Africa's largest producer of copper.

Its capital Kinshasa lies on the Congo River, the only African river to cross the equator twice.

Countries Try Again to Seal Pandemic Treaty After Ebola Jolt



The DRC is home to several significant lakes, including Lake Tanganyika, Lake Albert, Lake Edward, and Lake Kivu.

Mount Nyiragongo, an active volcano in the Virunga Mountains, is one of the country's notable geological features.

Countries Try Again to Seal Pandemic Treaty After Ebola Jolt

- **The Trigger**

- WHO member states resumed talks on the pandemic treaty's missing piece, with a DRC Ebola outbreak (1,561 confirmed cases, 506 deaths, spilling into Uganda) adding urgency

- **Background**

- The pandemic agreement, struck after three years of negotiations sparked by COVID-19, was adopted in May 2025, but its key operational mechanism was left undecided to secure the deal

- **The Sticking Point : PABS**

- The Pathogen Access and Benefit-Sharing (PABS) system, meant to govern sharing pathogen samples and resulting benefits (vaccines, tests, treatments), was due to be finalised by May 2026 but progress has been slow

- **The Divide**

- Wealthy and developing countries remain at loggerheads over how the pandemic agreement will work in practice, particularly around equitable, timely access to benefits

- **The Objective**

- The accord aims to prevent a repeat of COVID-19's disjointed international response by improving global coordination, surveillance and timely vaccine access

Countries Try Again to Seal Pandemic Treaty After Ebola Jolt

Q. Among the following, which were frequently mentioned in the news for the outbreak of Ebola virus recently? (2015)

- (a) Syria and Jordan
- (b) Guinea, Sierra Leone and Liberia
- (c) Philippines and Papua New Guinea
- (d) Jamaica, Haiti and Surinam

Ans: (b)

Countries Try Again to Seal Pandemic Treaty After Ebola Jolt

About three-fourths of world's cobalt, a metal required for the manufacture of batteries for electric motor vehicles, is produced by

This question was previously asked in
UPSC Civil Services Prelims...

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1. Argentina
2. Botswana
3. Democratic Republic of the Congo
4. Kazakhstan

Countries Try Again to Seal Pandemic Treaty After Ebola Jolt

Consider the following pairs:

Country – Resource-rich in

I. Botswana : Diamond

II. Chile : Lithium

III. Indonesia : Nickel

In how many of the above rows is the given information correctly matched?

[Select an option to attempt](#)

☐ A Only one

☐ B Only two

☐ C All the three

☐ D None

Indira Point: Inside the Plan to Protect Lighthouse, Develop Tourism Hub

Indira Point: Inside the plan to protect lighthouse, develop tourism hub

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, July 8

THE UNION Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways has proposed protection and development works at Indira Point and the famous lighthouse at the site in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands. Through the Directorate of Lighthouses and Lightships, Sri Vijaya Puram (formerly Port Blair), an agency under the ministry, the Centre has sought coastal regulation zone clearance to carry out the proposed work.

Indira Point is India's southernmost tip, located on the Great Nicobar Island (GNI) in the Union Territory (UT) of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands. It is an important maritime landmark, and lies to the south of the Galathea Bay, where a transshipment port has been proposed under the GNI mega infrastructure project.

The government proposal

The Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, through the Directorate Gen-

eral of Lighthouses and Lightships, wants to structurally repair and eventually develop tourism infrastructure and facilities around the lighthouse.

The Centre wants to strengthen the structure, the immediate site around it and along with it, it has proposed a string of development activities. After the visit of Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal in late November 2023, the project was approved by the Central Advisory Committee of Aids to Navigation to "preserve and protect the lighthouse for its functional requirement for safety of mariners, rich legacy of region, for historic and cultural significant for future generations", as per the project's environmental impact assessment study.

As per a detailed project report by IIT Madras for the proposed development works, structural reinforcements will include repair and strengthening of the lighthouse tower's foundation, an all-weather approach road, shore protection works with break waters around the tower, power-

Maritime landmark

- The lighthouse at Indira Point is an important landmark on the Singapore-Colombo international maritime route and is used as a navigational aid.

- It also holds importance for safe navigation towards the Galathea Bay in the coming times, where a transshipment port has been proposed.

house, inspection and staff quarters, compound wall and internal pathways.

Separately, development activities for tourism promotion have been proposed. These include eco-tourism, convention centre, cafeteria, viewing tower, cycle tracks, and an international standard museum building as well as a memorial structure.

The need for protection

The works proposed fall in sensitive coastal habitats, which are protected under the Island Coastal Regulation Zone Notification, 2019. So, it needs prior approval from the UT's Coastal Zone Management Authority and the Environment Ministry. The notification provides a regulatory framework for protection of coastal stretches, marine habitats and livelihoods of fisher and other coastal communities across the group of islands.

The lighthouse structure has faced weathering. The structural issues it faces can also be attributed to the changes it faced during the December 2004 earth-

quake and tsunami. The 2004 natural calamity had a huge impact on the entire island group, causing uplift in some areas and land sinking in others.

The site where Indira Point is situated, specifically, faced permanent land subsidence at the time. Originally, the site of the lighthouse and associated structures was at a height of 3.5 m above mean sea level. When the earthquake and tsunami struck the island, the land sinking and the inland ingress of the sea engulfed the lighthouse tower while destroying quarters and huts around it. Scientists and authorities have estimated that the Nicobar islands sunk 2.04 m, thus submerging the lighthouse base and foundation in sea.

The geological and shoreline changes have exposed the foundation to seawater since 2004, extreme wave conditions during high tide, as per the IIT Madras assessment. The lighthouse also shows a 3.86° inclination or tilt, which was, however, not considered as a risk to its structural stability or safety.

Indira Point: Inside the Plan to Protect Lighthouse, Develop Tourism Hub

- **The Proposal**

- The Union Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways has proposed protection and development works at Indira Point and its lighthouse on Great Nicobar Island, India's southernmost tip

- **Strategic and Maritime Importance**

- The lighthouse is a key landmark on the Singapore-Colombo international maritime route and aids navigation toward Galathea Bay, where a transshipment port is proposed under the Great Nicobar mega infrastructure project

- **Why Protection Is Needed**

- The 2004 tsunami caused the Nicobar Islands to sink by 2.04 metres, submerging the lighthouse's base and foundation; the structure now shows a 3.86-degree tilt and faces exposure to seawater and extreme wave conditions

IMF Lowers Global Growth Forecast to 3%, India's to 6.4%

IMF lowers global growth forecast to 3%, India's to 6.4%

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, July 8

THE INTERNATIONAL Monetary Fund (IMF) on Wednesday lowered its global growth forecast for 2026 by a marginal 10 basis points (bps) to 3% on the assumption that the Strait of Hormuz begins re-opening in mid-July and the situation broadly returns to prewar state by March 2027 — even as US President Donald Trump said he thinks the ceasefire with Iran is over.

On Wednesday, Trump said the ceasefire was a “just a waste of time”. Hours earlier, the US hit over 80 Iranian military targets after merchant ships were attacked in the Strait of Hormuz, with Washington also revoking a license that authorized the sale of Iranian oil.

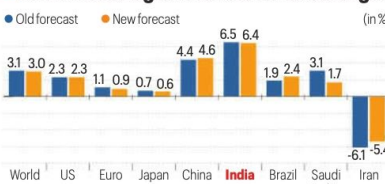
While released on Wednesday at 6:30pm India time, the IMF’s economic projections were prepared earlier.

“The most imminent risk to the baseline forecast stems from developments in the Middle East,” the IMF said in a quarterly update to its World Economic Outlook report.

“Renewed conflict would propagate through a further increase in commodity prices and extended volatility, supply shortages, and exchange rate pressures. The muted increase in oil prices and their contained impact on activity owe to the release of inventories, which are now getting closer to multi-year lows and could reach stress levels should supply disruptions persist or hoarding gather steam,” the multilateral agency added.

The tentative ceasefire helped placate markets across the world after the start of the conflict on February 27 led to a sharp rise in global energy prices

How IMF's 2026 growth forecasts have changed



NOTE: INDIA, IRAN GROWTH FORECASTS ARE FOR FISCAL YEARS; SOURCE: IMF

following the closure of the key waterway, Strait of Hormuz. The price of India's crude oil basket, which had surged 66% from February to \$114.48 per barrel in April, has cooled sharply to \$68.62 so far in July, according to petroleum ministry data.

However, the renewal of hostilities by the US has already begun to weigh heavy on financial markets and investors, with benchmark Indian equity indices slumping more than 2% on Wednesday. In line with the trimming of the global growth forecast, the IMF on Wednesday slightly lowered its projection for India's GDP growth in 2026-27 — also by 10 bps — to 6.4%. This is lower than the Reserve Bank of India's forecast of 6.6%.

“India remains among the fastest growing major economies, with growth projected at 6.4%, supported by strong momentum in private consumption and services activity,” the agency said, even as it raised the forecast for 2027-28 by 20 bps from April to 6.7%. In calendar year 2026, the IMF sees India's GDP growing 7%, before cooling to 6.4% in 2027.

China, meanwhile, got a 20-bps bump-up to 4.6% for 2026 and 10 bps for 2027 to 4.1%. Brazil, meanwhile, is seen growing half-a-percentage point faster

than previously thought this year at 2.4%. In the West Asia region, the IMF expects Saudi Arabia's economy to expand by 1.7% in 2026, down from its forecast of 3.1% in April.

“Iraq, Kuwait, and Qatar — commodity producers most affected by disruptions to energy output and transport — are projected to experience sharp contractions of their economies in 2026, followed by double-digit expansions in 2027.”

Iran's economy is expected to shrink by 5.4% in its 2026 fiscal year.

According to the IMF, the world economy has, so far, weathered the shock from the US-Israel-Iran war “better than feared”. Global growth is seen slowing only modestly from 3.5% in 2024-2025 due to the hit from the conflict being “partly offset by accelerated demand-driven momentum in the global technology cycle thanks to advances in artificial intelligence (AI) and its adoption”.

Commodity prices, however, remain elevated, the IMF said, with energy prices around 25% higher than prewar levels. This, along with higher inflation numbers, have raised inflation expectations.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

IMF Lowers Global Growth Forecast to 3%, India's to 6.4%

- **The Revision**

- IMF lowered its 2026 global growth forecast by 10 basis points to 3%, and India's forecast by 10 bps to 6.4%, citing risks from the Strait of Hormuz closure and renewed US-Iran tensions

- **India's Relative Position**

- Despite the downward revision, India remains among the fastest-growing major economies; growth for 2027-28 was raised by 20 bps to 6.7%, though the 2026-27 figure is lower than the RBI's own forecast of 6.6%

- **The Middle East Shock**

- US strikes on Iranian military targets and revocation of an Iranian oil sale licence renewed hostilities; India's crude oil basket price had surged 66% before cooling as the Strait of Hormuz reopens

- **Divergent Country Impacts**

- China's forecast was revised up to 4.6%; Saudi Arabia's growth forecast was cut to 1.7%; Iran's economy is expected to shrink by 5.4% in its 2026 fiscal year

- **The Broader Picture**

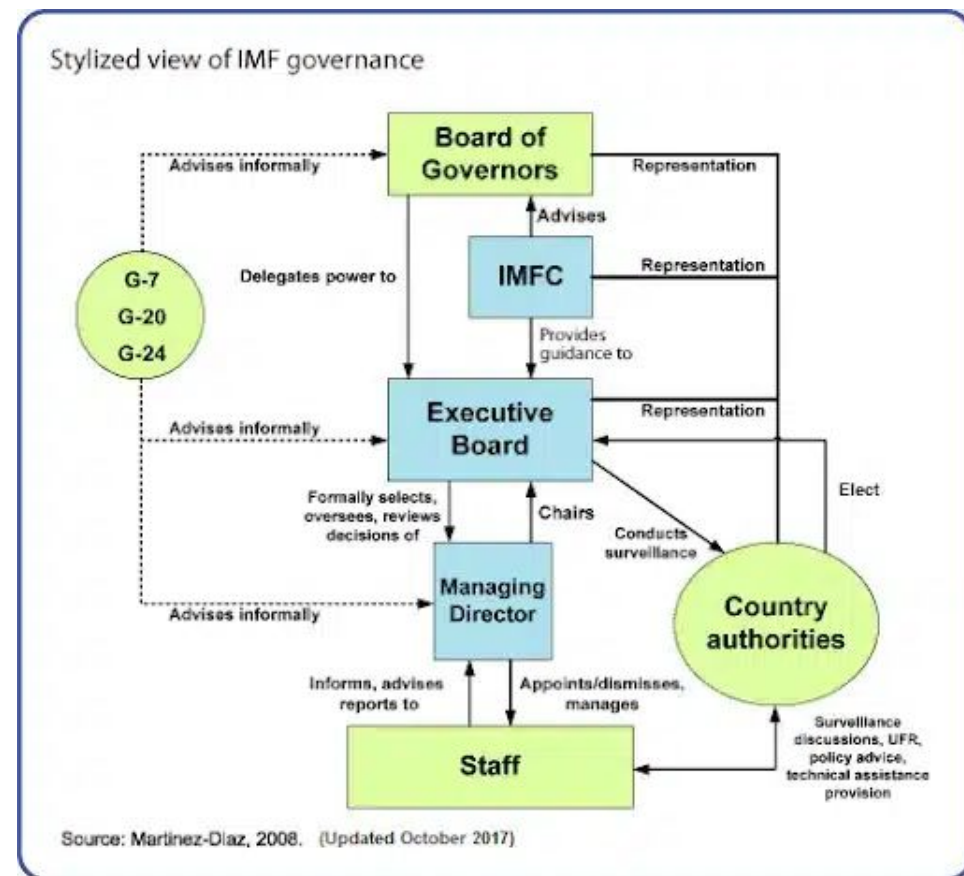
- Global growth has so far weathered the US-Israel-Iran conflict shock "better than feared", partly offset by AI-driven technology cycle momentum, though elevated commodity prices continue to raise inflation expectations

IMF Lowers Global Growth Forecast to 3%, India's to 6.4%

- International Monetary Fund (IMF) is a global financial institution established in 1944 during the Bretton Woods Conference.
- International Monetary Fund (IMF) is a global financial institution that promotes international monetary cooperation and financial stability.

Structure.

- **Board of Governors:** The highest decision-making body of the IMF, meeting annually to approve quota increases and SDR allocations, admit new members, and compel member withdrawals. Each member country has one governor and one alternate governor.
- The Finance Minister of India is an ex-officio Governor, with the RBI Governor as the Alternate Governor.
- **International Monetary and Financial Committee (IMFC):** IMFC advises the Board of Governors on matters related to the management of the international monetary and financial



The Significance of Astra Missiles, Which Indonesia Will Purchase

The significance of Astra missiles, which Indonesia will purchase

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, July 8

INDIA AND Indonesia on Tuesday reached a significant milestone in their growing strategic cooperation by signing a deal for the supply of the Astra Mk 1 'beyond-visual-range air-to-air missiles' (BVRAAM).

Beyond-visual-range missiles are those capable of engaging beyond the range of 20 nautical miles, or 37 km. Air-to-air missiles are primarily fired from an airborne asset to destroy an airborne target.

The development is significant as it marks India's first export of Astra missiles to another country. These missiles will arm Indonesia's Su-30 fleet.

The missile and its variants

Developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation, Astra is a family of indigenous BVRAAMs that will be integrated with the Air Force and the Navy.

The first in the family, Astra Mk 1, has a range of 80 to 110 km, an altitude of up to 20 km and a speed of Mach 4.5 (or 4.5 times the speed of sound).

MISSILE EXPORTS

- The India-Indonesia pact marks the first export of Astra missiles to another country.
- India is also set to supply the BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles to Indonesia, as well as to Vietnam and the Philippines.

A more advanced version — the Astra Mk 2 — has an enhanced range of 200 km, from the earlier decided range of around 160 km. This missile variant was granted the Acceptance of Necessity by the Defence Acquisition Council in December, indicating the government's interest in starting the procurement process soon, even as it is still in various phases of testing. They will also be integrated into the latest fighter jets of the IAF once inducted.

The Astra Mk 3 is still under development by the DRDO. Officially named Gandiva, it will be India's most advanced BVRAAM. It will likely be powered by a Solid Fuel Ducted Ramjet (SFDR) engine, allowing it to maintain continuous thrust mid-flight rather than burning out like conventional rocket motors.

Earlier this year, the DRDO had conducted a flight test of its SFDR technology for the Astra Mk 3, which could have a range of over 350 km.

A key part of the arsenal

The missile will be a counter to the long-range PL-15 in use by both Pakistan and China. The PL-15 is an advanced, very long-range, active radar-guided air-to-air missile developed by China.

Operation Sindoor, launched by India against Pakistan last year, demonstrated the criticality of longer-range BVRAAM missiles — and Astra is India's indigenous answer to that. A key focus area of the IAF is now to procure more batches of modern BVRAAM missiles. The Astra programme will help India build greater self-reliance, instead of depending solely on other imported air-to-air missiles such as the Meteor and R-77.

The Significance of Astra Missiles, Which Indonesia Will Purchase

- **The Deal**

- India and Indonesia signed a deal for the supply of Astra Mk 1 Beyond-Visual-Range Air-to-Air Missiles (BVRAAM), marking India's first export of Astra missiles to another country; will arm Indonesia's Su-30 fleet

- **About Astra**

- Developed indigenously by DRDO, Astra Mk 1 has a range of 80-110 km, an altitude reach of 20 km, and a speed of Mach 4.5; integrated with the IAF's Sukhoi-30 MKI, with future integration planned for Tejas Mk1A and Rafale jets

- **Next-Generation Variants**

- Astra Mk 2 offers an enhanced range of 200 km and has received Acceptance of Necessity; Astra Mk 3 (Gandiva), under development, targets over 350 km range using Solid Fuel Ducted Ramjet (SFDR) technology

- **Strategic Rationale**

- Astra serves as India's indigenous counter to China's long-range PL-15 missile, in use by both Pakistan and China; Operation Sindoor demonstrated the criticality of longer-range BVRAAM capability

- **Wider Export Push**

- Beyond Astra, India is also set to supply BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles to Indonesia, Vietnam and the Philippines, reflecting a broader defence export and self-reliance push

The Astra Missile Family: Range Progression

Astra Mk 1

80–110 km

In service; arms IAF Su-30 MKI;
exported to Indonesia

Astra Mk 2

~200 km

Received Acceptance of Necessity;
in testing

Astra Mk 3 (Gandiva)

350+ km

Under development;
SFDR-powered sustained thrust

Thank You